



Figure 1: Google Summer of Code (GSoc)



Figure 2: GNOME's Outreach Program for Women (OPW)

- To inspire young developers to begin participating in open source development
- Provide students in computer science and related fields the opportunity to do work related to their academic pursuits, during the summer
- Give students more exposure to real-world software development scenarios (e.g., distributed development, software licensing questions, mailing-list etiquette, etc)
- Get more open source code created and released for the benefit of all
- Help open source projects identify and bring in new developers and committers

The programme offers a stipend of US\$ 5500 and is conducted entirely online. Students and mentors from more than 100 countries have participated over the past years.

GNOME's Outreach Program for Women (OPW):

OPW is a programme that encourages women to contribute to FOSS. It offers a stipend of US\$ 5500. It provides a supportive community for beginners to contribute any time throughout the year, and offers focused internship opportunities twice a year with a number of free software organisations. This work is continued by Outreach, with the goal of expanding the programme to more participants from under-represented demographic sectors.

By having a programme targeted specifically towards women, GNOME plans to reach talented and passionate women, who are uncertain about how to start out on the FOSS path, otherwise. GNOME is now expanding the programme to people from groups under-represented in FOSS. They hope this effort will help many people to discover how exciting, varied and valuable working on FOSS projects can be, and how inclusive the community really is. This programme is a welcome link that will connect participants with people working on individual projects in various FOSS organisations and guide them through their first contributions.

Google Code-In (GCI) for high school students: The Google Code-In contest gives high school students around the world an opportunity to explore the world of open source development. Participants complete tasks of their choice for a variety of open source software projects. Students can earn t-shirts, certificates and hoodies for their work and 24 dedicated students from around the world (two chosen from



Figure 3: Google Code-In (GCI)

each software project) win a trip to Google's headquarters in Mountain View, CA, USA.

Since open source development is much more than just computer programming, there are lots of different kinds of tasks to choose from, in five broad categories:

- **Code:** Writing or re-factoring code
- **Documentation/Training:** Creating and editing documentation and helping others learn
- **Outreach/Research:** Community management and outreach/marketing, or studying problems and recommending solutions
- **Quality assurance:** Testing to ensure code is of high quality
- **User interface:** User experience research or user interface design

Getting involved with the community

First and foremost, be an open source user! There are open source solutions for nearly every need you can imagine, and chances are, you've already used a few. From browsers like Firefox to email clients like Thunderbird, and from content management systems like Wordpress to media players like VLC, much of the software that powers the Internet is open source. So, start involving yourself with the FOSS communities.

Communication with the organisation is very important in FOSS. Every organisation has its own way of communicating. Some prefer mailing lists, others the IRC and a few use Asana, Bootcamp, etc. Whatever it is, be an active member. Again, an important thing to remember is to make your presence felt amongst the developer community. But always remember to ask *intelligent* questions.

Selecting the organisation you want to work with is the most important factor. Being clear about the kind of organisation you want to contribute to is a very hard thing to do, and is one of the few stages at which people go wrong. For this, you should shortlist your interests, research the organisation and know what you are interested in working on.

Regarding getting accepted in any of the programmes, some organisations expect you to do minor bug fixing/development tasks. Others are more interested in your profile and interests. It also depends on the size, scale and platform of the project. There might be competency tests, one-on-one